

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 728 MAY 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Summer Rock 2010

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 3 May 2010

Adventures in Sichuan China – “unclimbed peaks, fervent hairstylists and dodgy politics” by Penny Goddard



In April-May 2009, I teamed up with Lydia Bradey and Americans Mark Jenkins and Kenny Gasch to attempt the first ascent of Nyambo Konka (6114m). What followed was a month of adventure – storms and difficulties on Nyambo Konka, an hilarious sojourn into the city, the use of bribery and cunning to get back into the mountains and finally, a first ascent of a rock peak in a beautiful unmapped Tibetan valley.

Wellington Section Photo Competition 2010



Last Year's Champion Alpine Nature
"Ice Palace: Tasman from the the Trough" by Bruce Van Brunt

The annual Wellington Section photo competition is on. This year we will have a panel of judges: John Rhodes, Shaun Barnett, Andy Reisinger, and Matt Evans.

The results will be presented at the section night on Monday 14 June where the panel will present a selection of the best shots for the audience to choose the winners.

See your best photos on the big screen, get feedback from photography experts, vote on this year's best shots, and be in to win great prizes from our sponsors.

Entries close Thursday 20 May

HOW TO TAKE PART

- 1) Pick out your best pictures for the following categories:
 - Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
 - Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
 - Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
 - Rock Climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
 - Photo Journalism: the shot that tells a story
 - Humour: whatever gets you a laugh

- 2) Fill out the attached Entry Form and email it and your photographs to wgtnphotocomp@gmail.com. Alternatively you can drop off your entries at Bivouac, 25 Mercer St, Wellington.
- 3) If entering slides or prints, please scan them first – we need all entries to be in digital format. Maximum of three entries per category per person – thanks!

For further info contact Hinrich Schaefer on 021 298 6894 or by email at wgtnphotocomp@gmail.com

This year's photo competition is sponsored by:



Hikurangi Range, by Richard Davies
Winner of the 2009 NZAC Wellington Photo Competition



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Summer Rock 2010

"Each year the dice are rolled and a random group turns up to be Summer Rocked. There is always a fascinating cross section: the alpinist, the never climbed before newbie, the climbs hard on plastic, the return to rock after many years, the scared of falling, the adrenaline junkie, the scared of heights, the short, the tall. This year was no exception and looking at the students it was impossible to guess what surprises were in store."

Douglas Talbot, Instructor.

A mixed bag we certainly were: 12 eager students of ranging ages and backgrounds just about matched 1:1 by an equally varied crew of instructors all of whom had generously offered to teach us their skills over seven weeks of summer. We all trotted down to the weekly Tuesday night sessions at Ferg's and on two day trips locally, the big highlights being two weekends away to richer rock grounds in scenic spots.



"The combination of the 'safe' indoor experiences at Fergs and the challenges that the outdoor climbing experiences gave us provided a really good learning experience.

At Ferg's we could try things out, practice routines, and begin to apply techniques. Climbing outside in contrast provided the 'step up' in pushing the personal envelope but amongst a supportive and encouraging bunch of other climbers"

Peter Crosland, Student.

Movement, abseiling, anchors and leading were the key subjects to cover but at all times the course was flexible and student-led. Whilst covering the required basics we also got to decide what to focus on given our personal goals. The instructors were open to questions and happy to share anecdotes. We mingled freely and made the journey at our own pace.



"It's a real buzz being involved in the course - not only do you meet a bunch of nice people but seeing their climbing skills improve over the course, in some cases quite dramatically, is fantastic. There is nothing quite like having to explain something you thought you knew about to someone else to make sure you really do know about it!"

Robin Maxwell, Instructor.

The relaxed vibe was certainly encouraged by the weather. It was so sunny it was too sunny for all this shirtless climbing I've seen plastered across the Climber magazine. Shades, sunscreen and something cold to drink were in high demand. After arriving sleepy in the chilly dark the night before and hurriedly pitching a tent, waking up to the tranquil waters and dramatic scenery of Whanganui Bay was an unexpected and welcome surprise and set the tone for the rest of the trip.

"Going to Whanganui Bay is definitely one of the most beautiful places I've seen in NZ since I've been here and doubt I would have if I hadn't been rock climbing"

Jin Ong, Student.

After a hot day on the rocks the waters of Lake Taupo refreshed tired bodies in preparation for a delicious meal from (refreshingly vegan-friendly) chef Scott Taylor. A bit of star gazing followed and then to bed with extra thermals, Anthony gratefully sampling some loaned and rather fetching ladies' PJs. Those feeling plucky resolved to take on Tibia the next day, an iconic 3-pitch grade 16 climb ending with a 50m abseil. One member of the team sustained a bruise on commencing this abseil and afterwards happily mooned it to anyone within flashing distance. Thanks for the memories Nina.

"The main highlight of Whanganui bay was the adventure we took scaling a climb called Rumble in the jungle. I was petrified just walking to the climb, we literally had to bush bash through a jungle to get there, it was clear no one had used the climb in forever.

Mike led first, then me and Kevin seconded it. Douglas sent us up some water then climbed up to meet us. Because of the blistering heat, Kevin had to make me a sunshade out of his tee shirt, so we had a bit of clothes swapping going on on our little ledge!"

Alaina Jury, Student.

I had my own adventure when Shichang casually suggested I try leading a grade 18 and somehow, after a lot of pausing and telling myself to harden up, I found myself at the top. Something I'm not sure I'll be matching for some time. I also had my first try at cleaning a climb and abseiling down without help. There's a definite rush as you take the safety clip off and lean back onto a system no instructor has helped you with, for me it defined the moment I was self sufficient and all the tuition had thankfully paid off.

Reluctantly it was time to head home, possibly some had prayed a bit too hard to stay - Richard's car, first up the rutted dirt road out, got stuck in a ditch. Lucky there were two minibus loads of strong men with enough muscle left to push it back on track. So in a dust cloud we said goodbye to the bay many hoping to make it back soon.

"Wharepapa was to be all about leading, and it certainly was. Every student managed to lead before the end of the weekend, a summer rock first I believe."

Douglas Talbot, Instructor.

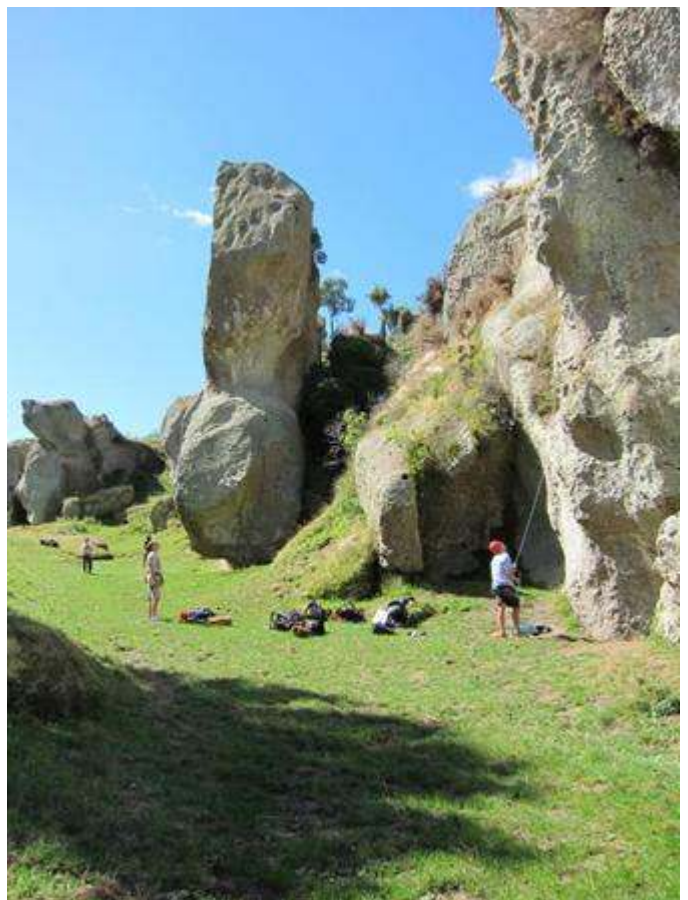
"The highlight for me at Wharepapa was spending the day at Sheridans with Douglas, Mike, and Anthony. We lead an 18 called Caynard, which was a triple star so according

to Mike that means it's a good climb. It was really scary, and I managed to thankfully not take any falls!"
Alaina Jury, Student.

"This involved a lot of swearing from above and a lot of nervous silence down below! In fact our visit to Sheridan's almost led to a new grading system measured by numbers of naughty words and millimetres of fingernail removed."
Douglas Talbot, Instructor.

"The trips away were definitely the highlights for me – an amazing mix of joy, fun, fear and being really scared but doing it anyway, camaraderie amongst the climbers and an amazing sense of achievement."
Peter Crosland, Student.

Wharepapa's Animal Biscuit valley provided more opportunity to climb on real rock, this stuff a bit sharper on the fingers but with plenty of soft semi-dried sheep and cow poo to break a fall. I especially enjoyed watching a number of instructors and students trying Up The Scoop Pure (the first stage of Lunar Leopard (21)). The girls definitely had the edge, instructor Claire took the prize for most graceful, and Douglas pulled out his slick movement skills to do it like no one else but it was shorty Alaina that impressed us the most, and me especially as I'm a shorty too, you don't need height, just that mixture Scot taught us on day one: 1/3 strength, 1/3 technique and 1/3 mental fortitude.



Wharepapa is a bloody long way from Wellington, Blair hadn't put iPod on his gear list without good reason. A combination of good music and good conversation helped the ride home go nicely and I now know the history of tango as regaled in detail by Doug.

Now the course is over and I've paid a trip to the climbing Mecca of Payne's Ford, a place filled with grunts, moans and many shirtless German men. I'm keeping up the evenings at Ferg's though sticking with top rope just for now, and looking forward to hearing everyone's news at the upcoming dinner.

As with the Alpine Instruction Course last year I found the friendliness and good will of everyone involved in Summer Rock 2010 welcoming and I'm very grateful for their time and good energy.

"I did this course to tie me over during summer when I can't ski and I can definitely say it's a great 'filler' and now I'm kind of hooked!"
Jin Ong, Student.

"All in all Summer Rock had an amazingly successful season and I was impressed by every student's dedication, attitude and progress."
Douglas Talbot, Instructor.

"One month after the course I did my first multi-pitch alpine rock climb under Double Cone, Remarkables. As I shivered while starting the first abseil in snow flurries and failing light I well remember Blair's mantra: You need to be able to abseil blind and cold. Thank you so much Blair!! And thank you so much to all the tutors!!!!"
Nina Sawicki, Student.

Report by Lauren Schaer

Two Thumbs up

Richard Davies and ex-section member Ben Ainsworth headed down to the Two Thumb range over Easter. Parking at Mesopotamia Station they crossed into the Macaulay via a dry and bland 2000m ridge. After sitting out a day of nor west at Macaulay hut they headed to the head of the valley in weather that an optimist would describe as 'clearing' and a metrologist would describe as 'raining'. They worked up onto the shelf of the unnamed glacier under the South face of Mt Earle (presumably should be called the Macaulay glacier) and camped at about 2100m in misty drizzle.

The next day was clear-ish with the weather threatening. They snuck up Earle (2410m) via the Murphy Glacier and the East ridge as appropriate, then descended the Murphy glacier and the length of Murphy stream. The crux of the day was finding a way around the bad gorge via thick scrub and steep guts. The onset of night meant the last bit of the gorge was an exercise in Braille reading on the big boulders and some deep dark crossings. They finally reached Mistake Flats hut and then spent a long time in the rain walking back to the car via the Havelock. There's a word for that. Interminable.

Richard Davies



Easter Bagging

Section members Simon Bell and Lorraine Johns tripped down to Arthur's Pass in April for some Easter peak bagging. Possibly more Easter eggs were bagged than peaks, but all activities were thoroughly enjoyed anyway (particularly when combined).

Day 1 saw a traverse from Mt Bealy to Avalanche Peak, through a mixture of sunny and whiteout conditions, and with some enjoyable tops travel. The rocky ridge is quite varied which possibly makes it a more interesting trip to do before the snow falls. Our series of summit successes ended there as day 2 saw an aborted attempt on Mt Philistine via the Warnock bluffs (conditions were such that we couldn't see the turn off to the road end). The mountains were replaced by a saunter up Hut Spur from Top Bealy Hut in the Black Range to point 1581 in sunny, though windy, conditions. We enjoyed clear views of the surrounding hills and valley below, as well as thick clag enveloping the mountains around the township.

Day 3 saw us join David Jewell and Sharron Came's WTMC trip to Mounts Murchison and Harper. Ideal summiting conditions were encountered on the walk in with great views of Rolleston and Barker Hut on the approach. We camped in a very sheltered, flat spot, on an attractive patch of grass behind the Barker Hut tarn.



The summit is the highest point

Views disappeared from day 4 on, although we still headed up Mt Murchison to check out the crevasses in the White Glacier and the Murchison summit rocks. We couldn't really see too much of either, but we did notice the crevasses when we poked our legs through snowbridges and the summit rocks got our attention when we heard them crashing down on the helmet-clad head of an unfortunate climber ahead of us. That night the weather took a further turn for the worse and we discovered that the grass growing under our tent was doing so well due to being in the centre of the tarn overflow outlet...

Day 5 saw no improvement in the weather. Even the wind direction didn't change - which really wasn't good news, as the toilet had no door and the wind and rain both came from a sub-optimal direction, all things considered. There wasn't much to do except eat too many jellybeans for breakfast and cheat in a pull up competition initiated by the boys, both of which made a quick exit to take a trip up to White Col quite necessary. This also gave me the opportunity to check out the few metres I could see of the Harper route from the saddle. I thought it looked puzzlingly intimidating for an easier peak, but this turned out to be because I was looking at the 3- instead of the 1+ route. Better to read the route description before, rather than after, you recce a climb I guess. We headed down to Carrington Hut in the late afternoon when the rain began to lessen.

Day 6 saw us walking out in the clag (which naturally cleared once we reached Klondyke Corner) to discover what they say about parking your car at an Arthur's Pass roadend is pretty much correct... We drove back to Christchurch on day 7, discovering that travelling with no rear window makes things a bit drafty, especially when it is cold and raining. The combined effect was to sabotage our plans to bag another peak in a whiteout. Instead we spent the day drinking hot chocolate, catching up with Canty-Westlanders, and gear shopping. Best discovery was a \$2 curry shop, though I might wait 'til I'm quite hungry on the next adventure before trying those curries out...

Lorraine Johns



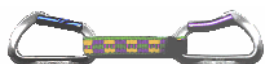


UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Kawakawa Bay

Date: 7-9 May 2010

Leader: Steve Minchin

Level: Rock grade 13-22+

Take a trip to the newly developed crag of Kawakawa Bay. Come along for a weekend of sport and trad climbing on some quality rock, against the backdrop of Lake Taupo. Explore the large number of mid-grade climbs available including the classic two pitch High Hopes (16). Contact Steve by email at sm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Kawakawa Bay – photo by Kevin Robertshaw



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku

Date: 4-7 June 2010 (Queen's Birthday weekend)

Leader: Waimaria Erueti

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Waimaria at 380 6277(h) or 027 289 3024 or by email at waimariaerueti@gmail.com



Ruapehu South

Date: 9-11 July 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga

Date: 13-15 August 2010

Leader: Peter Ellis

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Peter at 021 934 482 (evenings) or email him at ellisp@netspeed.com.au



CLASSIFIEDS



La Sportiva Makalu

These have barely been used - my brother got conned into buying them when he really just wanted tramping boots. Shaped toe for crampon attachment. Leather upper / Vibram sole. Contact Philippa 021 202 4358



NOTICES



Old Darrans Guidebooks

NZAC still has some limited copies of the 1990 pocket-size Darrans guides in stock, which we're keen to get rid of ie they're FREE. Drop into National Office in Chch to grab one, or send us a stamped, self addressed envelope. Available while stocks last!



Mining on conservation land

The message below is distributed to you for your information, to act upon at a PERSONAL or INDIVIDUAL level. NZAC does not have a position on mining at this stage.

Schedule 4 Means "You"!

You will have heard plenty on the radio and television about the Government's Schedule 4 Minerals Stocktake. You will hopefully have read the FMC Bulletin articles on the subject and newspaper articles. Go to www.2precious2mine.org.nz to refresh your memory. This is the biggest crisis for the back country for decades.

Each and every one of us needs to take some action to make sure that we never see Rakiura, Fiordland or Mt Aspiring the home for open-cast mines (forget about surgical precision mining in these places - it's impossible). Rakiura is on the second-wave hit list and if the Government agrees to making Schedule 4 protection optional, then it can only be a matter of time before miners take on Fiordland.

In 1970, 264,907 New Zealanders, almost 10% of the population, signed the Save Manapouri petition. Read between the lines and you will see that the Government is torn internally over the prospect of mining in National Parks. It's time for 264,907 new New Zealanders to submit against mining Schedule 4 lands. Your voice can make a difference. Go to www.2precious2mine.org.nz to find links to the Government's discussion documents and other information.

When you submit:

1. Use pen and paper; don't make an electronic submission. "Public Inconvenience" is the modern equivalent to 1970's "Public Disobedience".
2. Copy your submission to Hon. Gerry Brownlee with an accompanying letter that he has to answer. Let him feel for us.
3. Make sure that you emphasise that the Minister of Conservation alone should be responsible for making decisions on access to Conservation Lands and that the Minister of Energy should have no involvement. This is most important.
4. Get it posted before Friday 30th April to get to MED before 5pm Tuesday 4th May.

Or, just write a letter and pour your heart out.

Send your submission and/or letter to both:

Schedule 4 Stocktake
Ministry of Economic Development
PO Box 1473
Wellington 6140

and

Hon Gerry Brownlee
Minister of Energy
Parliament Building
Wellington

One day your grandchildren will thank you.

Ollie Clifton
Executive Officer
New Zealand Alpine Club Inc.



Mt Cook Diesel Stop

The Mt Cook Diesel Stop (Main Road, Hermitage) will cease operation on Friday 30 April 2010. The closest alternative fuelling facilities are in Omarama and Tekapo.



Missing library books and DVDs

The following books and DVDs are missing from the Wellington Section's library – if you know where they might be please contact Derek at richard.derekson@gmail.com

- 379 Dunedin Rock by Dave Brash (2000)
- 384 Arthur's Pass - A guide for mountaineers by Graeme Kates (2004)
- 424 Alpine Skills 34 - Mountain Safety Council. by Geoff Wyatt (2005)
- 430 Extreme Alpinism by Mark Twight (1999)
- 433 The Darran Mountains by Craig Jeffries (2006)
- 443 The Boys of Everest by Clint Willis (2006)
- 462 Eiger Dreams - ventures amongst men and mountains by Jon Krakauer (1990)
- 469 Whanganui Rock by Len Gillman
- 470 Queenstown, Rock, Ice and Mixed by Guillame Charton (2008)
- 473 The Beckoning Silence DVD (2007)
- 477 How to climb 5.12 by Eric Horst (1997)



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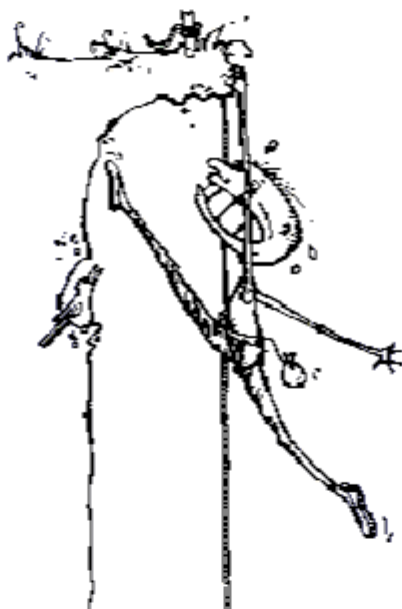


\$370



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Gwen Rashbrooke		
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
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